🏛 Indian Polity — Flowchart Memory Map

Constitution · Fundamental Rights & Duties · DPSP · Parliament · Executive & Judiciary · Amendments · Borrowed Features — drawn as trees & tables so articles register in one glance.

Target post: ASO · Tier-I General Awareness · Polity is the single highest-yield GK block. Every block tagged by priority.

P1 High-yield — do first P2 Medium P3 Low / rare 🧠 = mnemonic

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📅 **2026-07-04** · **Article of the day:** President/PM/Judiciary powers rotates daily

🌳 The Constitution in One Tree P1

Start here. The Constitution (adopted 26 Nov 1949, in force 26 Jan 1950) is divided into **Parts** → **Articles** → **Schedules**. Learn which Part holds which topic — most questions test exactly this mapping.

CONSTITUTION OF INDIA — key Parts

Part I	Union & its Territory (Art 1–4)
Part II	Citizenship (Art 5–11)
Part III	Fundamental Rights (Art 12–35) — justiciable
Part IV	DPSP (Art 36–51) — non-justiciable
Part IVA	Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — added 42nd
Part V	Union — President, Parliament, SC (Art 52–151)
Part VI	States — Governor, Legislature, HC (Art 152–237)
Part IX / IXA	Panchayats (243–243O) / Municipalities (243P–243ZG) — 73rd/74th
Part XVIII	Emergency Provisions (Art 352–360)
Part XX	Amendment of the Constitution (Art 368)

🧠 **"Citizen 3 rights, 4 directives, 4A duties"** → Part **III** = Rights, Part **IV** = DPSP, Part **IVA** = Duties. They sit side by side, so their numbers are easy to swap in a hurry.

Preamble — the ID card of the Constitution

WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA...

Nature	SOVEREIGN · SOCIALIST* · SECULAR* · DEMOCRATIC · REPUBLIC
Objectives	Justice · Liberty · Equality · Fraternity

🧠 Nature = **SSSDR** → **S**overeign **S**ocialist **S**ecular **D**emocratic **R**epublic. Objectives = **"JLEF"** (Justice, Liberty, Equality, Fraternity).

***42nd Amendment (1976)** added the words **SOCIALIST, SECULAR** and **INTEGRITY** to the Preamble. Preamble is based on the **Objectives Resolution** (moved by Nehru). In *Kesavananda Bharati (1973)* it was held to be part of the Constitution and amendable, but the **Basic Structure** cannot be altered. *Berubari (1960)* earlier said it was NOT part.

⚖️ Fundamental Rights — Part III (Art 12–35) P2

Now **6 rights** (Right to Property was the 7th, deleted by the 44th Amendment). They are justiciable — enforceable in court. Learn each right with its exact article range.



P1

1. Equality

Art 14–18

14 equality before law · 15 no discrimination · 16 public jobs · **17 no untouchability** · 18 no titles



P1

2. Freedom

Art 19–22

19 six freedoms · 20 conviction safeguards · **21 life & liberty** · 21A education · 22 arrest/detention



P2

3. Against Exploitation

Art 23–24

23 ban on trafficking & forced labour · 24 no child labour (<14) in factories



P2

4. Freedom of Religion

Art 25–28

25 profess/practise/propagate · 26 religious affairs · 27 no religion tax · 28 instruction



P2

5. Cultural & Educational

Art 29–30

29 protect minority culture/language · 30 minorities may run institutions



P1

6. Constitutional Remedies

Art 32

"Heart & soul" — Ambedkar · SC issues writs · HC = Art 226 (wider)

🧠 **"Every Frog Eats Really Cool Cake"** → **E**quality, **F**reedom, against **E**xploitation, **R**eligion, **C**ultural & Educational, **C**onstitutional Remedies. Ranges climb: **14 → 19 → 23 → 25 → 29 → 32.**

Right to Property: was Art 19(1)(f) & Art 31. The **44th Amendment (1978)** removed it as a Fundamental Right and made it a **legal/constitutional right under Art 300A**. So no longer a Fundamental Right.

The 5 Writs (Art 32 / 226) — a court's toolkit

WRIT	LITERAL MEANING	USED FOR	TAG
Habeas Corpus	"To have the body"	Produce a detained person before court; against illegal detention (private or public)	P1
Mandamus	"We command"	Orders a public official/body to do its legal duty (not against private persons)	P1
Prohibition	"To forbid / stay"	Issued by a higher court to a lower court to **stop** exceeding jurisdiction (before decision)	P2
Certiorari	"To be certified / informed"	Higher court **quashes** a lower court's order (after decision)	P2
Quo Warranto	"By what authority"	Questions the legality of a person's claim to a public office	P2

🧠 Writs = **"HaM PCQ"** → **Ha**beas Corpus, **M**andamus, **P**rohibition, **C**ertiorari, **Q**uo Warranto. Trick pair: **Prohibition = stop mid-way, Certiorari = cancel after done.**

PYQ pattern: "Which writ is issued to release a person from illegal detention?" → Habeas Corpus. · "Heart and soul of the Constitution?" → Art 32. · "Which article deals with abolition of untouchability?" → Art 17.

🙏 Fundamental Duties — Part IVA, Art 51A P3

The mirror image of Rights. Non-justiciable (cannot be enforced by court). Added later on a committee's advice — this "who & when" is the whole question.

Added by	**42nd Amendment, 1976** "Mini-Constitution"
On advice of	**Swaran Singh Committee**
Borrowed from	**erstwhile USSR (Russia)**
Article	**Art 51A** — single article listing all duties
Count	Originally **10**; now **11** — the 11th (parent to provide education to child 6–14) added by the **86th Amendment, 2002**

🧠 **"51A → 42 → Swaran Singh → 10, then 11 by 86th."** Rights are demanded, Duties are owed — Duties came 26 years later.

Trap: Fundamental Duties are **NOT** justiciable and are found only in **Art 51A**. The 11th duty came with the same amendment (86th) that inserted Art 21A (Right to Education) — link them together.

🎯 Directive Principles (DPSP) — Part IV, Art 36–51 P2

Ideals for the State to follow while making policy. **Non-justiciable** (not enforceable), but "fundamental in governance." Borrowed from **Ireland** (which took it from Spain).

DPSP — classified into 3 types

	SOCIALIST	GANDHIAN
Aim	Welfare state, reduce inequality	Gandhi's rural/village ideals
Eg.	Art 38 welfare Art 39 equal pay Art 41 work & education Art 43 living wage	Art 40 panchayats Art 43 cottage industry Art 46 SC/ST welfare Art 47 prohibition Art 48 cow slaughter

LIBERAL–INTELLECTUAL

Eg. Art 44 Uniform Civil Code · Art 45 early childhood care/education · Art 48 modern agriculture · Art 48A protect environment

Art 50 separate judiciary from executive | Art 51 promote international peace

The must-know DPSP articles

ARTICLE	DIRECTIVE	TAG
Art 40	Organisation of village **Panchayats**	P1
Art 44	Uniform Civil Code (**UCC**) for all citizens	P1
Art 45	Early childhood care & education (below 6) reworded by 86th	P2
Art 48	Agriculture & animal husbandry; ban cow slaughter	P2
Art 48A	Protect & improve **environment**, forests & wildlife added 42nd	P2
Art 50	Separation of judiciary from executive	P2

🧠 **Rights = justiciable (Court can enforce), DPSP = non-justiciable (only moral).** If Rights & DPSP conflict, in general FRs prevail (*Minerva Mills*), but Art 31C protects some laws made for Art 39(b)/(c).

🏛 Parliament — the Law-Making Machine P1

Parliament = **President + Lok Sabha + Rajya Sabha** (Art 79). The two houses differ on every point SSC loves to compare.

FEATURE	LOK SABHA (HOUSE OF THE PEOPLE)	RAJYA SABHA (COUNCIL OF STATES)
Max strength	552 (530 states + 20 UTs + 2 Anglo-Indian now abolished by 104th)	250 (238 elected + 12 nominated by President)
Term	5 years (can be dissolved)	**Permanent** — never dissolved; 1/3 retire every 2 yrs (6-yr term)
Who presides	**Speaker** (elected by the House)	**Vice-President** of India (ex-officio Chairman)
Min. age	25 years	30 years
Money Bills	**Originate ONLY here**; Rajya Sabha can only delay 14 days & recommend	Cannot originate or reject a Money Bill (Art 110)
No-confidence	Only Lok Sabha can pass it (govt is responsible to LS)	Cannot move a no-confidence motion

FEATURE	LOK SABHA (HOUSE OF THE PEOPLE)	RAJYA SABHA (COUNCIL OF STATES)
motion		

🧠 **Money Bill = Lok Sabha's baby.** Rajya Sabha can only rock the cradle 14 days. Speaker certifies whether a bill is a Money Bill — his decision is final.

Executive chain of accountability

PRESIDENT → PRIME MINISTER → COUNCIL OF MINISTERS → LOK SABHA

Rule President appoints PM (leader of majority in LS). PM advises President on other ministers. Council is **collectively responsible to the Lok Sabha** (Art 75).

How a Bill becomes a Law

Step 1 Introduction + **First Reading** (title read)

Step 2 **Second Reading** — general discussion → committee stage → clause-by-clause

Step 3 **Third Reading** — vote; passed by first House

Step 4 Sent to **second House** → same 3 stages (deadlock → **joint sitting** under Art 108, presided by **Speaker**)

Step 5 **President's assent** (Art 111) → becomes an **Act**. President may return an ordinary bill once (suspensive veto)

Sessions: 3 in a year — **Budget** (Feb–May), **Monsoon** (Jul–Sep), **Winter** (Nov–Dec). Max gap between two sessions cannot exceed **6 months** (Art 85). **Quorum = 1/10** of total members. **Zero Hour** is an Indian innovation (not in rules).

🤵 President · PM · Judiciary P2

PRESIDENT (Art 52–78)

Elected by **Electoral College** — elected MPs (LS+RS) + elected MLAs, by **single transferable vote /**

PM & COUNCIL (Art 74–75)

Art 74 Council of Ministers headed by PM to **aid & advise** the President — advice is **binding** (42nd/44th)

	proportional representation (Art 54–55)
Term	5 years; eligible for re-election; min age **35**
Art 72	**Pardoning power** — pardon, reprieve, respite, remission, commute (incl. death sentence)
Removal	By **impeachment** for "violation of Constitution" (Art 61)

Art 75	PM appointed by President; ministers hold office during his pleasure; **collectively responsible to Lok Sabha**
Size cap	Council ≤ **15%** of Lok Sabha strength (91st Amendment)

Supreme Court & Judicial Review

SUPREME COURT (Art 124–147)

Art 124	Establishes the SC; Chief Justice + other judges appointed by President; retire at **65**
Judicial Review	SC/HC can declare a law **unconstitutional** (void) if it violates the Constitution — borrowed from **USA**
Art 32 & 226	SC (32) & HC (226) issue **writs**; 226 is wider (covers legal rights too)
Basic Structure	*Kesavananda Bharati (1973)* — Parliament cannot amend the "basic structure" of the Constitution

🧠 **President = 35, retires never (5-yr term); Judge = retires at 65; SC judge appointed under Art 124.** Art 72 = President pardon; Art 161 = Governor pardon (but Governor can't pardon death sentence).

📜 Landmark Amendments P1

Amendments come under **Art 368**. Ride the timeline — each stop is the **number → year → one big change**. These repeat almost every year.

📜 **the amendments that matter**

42nd
1976

"Mini-Constitution" P1

Added **Socialist · Secular · Integrity** to Preamble; added **Fundamental Duties (Art 51A)**; made ministerial advice binding

44th 1978

Undid Emergency excesses P1

Removed Right to Property as a FR → legal right (Art 300A); "internal disturbance" → "armed rebellion"

61st 1988

Voting age lowered P2

21 → 18 years

73rd 1992

Panchayati Raj 🏘️ P1

Rural local govt · Part IX · **11th Schedule**

74th 1992

Municipalities 🏙️ P1

Urban local govt (Nagar Palika) · Part IXA · **12th Schedule**

86th 2002

Right to Education 🎓 P1

Added **Art 21A (RTE 6–14)** + the **11th Fundamental Duty**; reworded Art 45

101st 2016

GST 🧾 P2

Introduced **Goods & Services Tax**

🧠 **Twins 73 & 74 = local government** (73 rural 🏘️ · 74 urban 🏙️). **86 = 21A + 11th duty** (education). **42 built, 44 corrected** — the 44th undid the Emergency-era excesses of the 42nd.

Basic Structure doctrine (from *Kesavananda Bharati, 1973*) limits Art 368: Parliament can amend any part but NOT destroy the "basic structure" (democracy, secularism, judicial review, federalism, etc.). Reaffirmed in *Minerva Mills (1980)*.

🌍 Borrowed Features — Country → Feature P2

The Constitution is a "borrowed bag." SSC asks "X was borrowed from which country?" — learn the country → feature map.

COUNTRY	FEATURES BORROWED	TAG
UK (Britain)	Parliamentary govt, Rule of Law, Single citizenship, Cabinet, Speaker, Bicameralism, Writs	P1
USA	**Fundamental Rights, Judicial Review, Preamble**, Independent judiciary, Impeachment of President, VP as RS Chairman	P1

COUNTRY	FEATURES BORROWED	TAG
Ireland	**DPSP**, Nomination of RS members, Method of Presidential election	P1
Canada	**Federation with strong Centre**, Residuary powers with Centre, Appointment of Governors	P2
Australia	Concurrent List, Joint sitting of Parliament, Freedom of trade & commerce	P2
USSR (Russia)	**Fundamental Duties**, ideal of Justice in Preamble	P2
Germany (Weimar)	Suspension of Fundamental Rights during Emergency	P3
France	Republic, ideals of Liberty, Equality, Fraternity	P3
South Africa	Amendment procedure (Art 368), Election of RS members	P3
Japan	"Procedure established by law" (Art 21)	P3

🧠 Big three to never mix up: **FRs & Judicial Review = USA · DPSP = Ireland · Fundamental Duties = USSR · Parliamentary system = UK.** The **Govt of India Act 1935** gave the biggest chunk (federal scheme, office of Governor, judiciary).

⚡ 60-Second Rapid Revision P1

PROMPT	ANSWER
Constitution adopted / came into force	26 Nov 1949 / 26 Jan 1950
Fundamental Rights — Part & Articles	Part III, Art 12–35
Number of Fundamental Rights now	6 (Right to Property removed by 44th)
"Heart and soul" of the Constitution	Art 32 (Right to Constitutional Remedies) — Ambedkar
Writ against illegal detention	Habeas Corpus
Right to Education article	Art 21A (added by 86th Amendment)
Fundamental Duties — article & part	Art 51A, Part IVA (added by 42nd, Swaran Singh Committee)
Number of Fundamental Duties now	11 (11th added by 86th)
DPSP — Part & Articles, borrowed from	Part IV, Art 36–51, from Ireland

PROMPT	ANSWER
Uniform Civil Code / Panchayats article	Art 44 / Art 40
Environment protection (DPSP)	Art 48A (added by 42nd)
Money Bill can originate in	Lok Sabha only (Art 110)
Who presides over Rajya Sabha	Vice-President (ex-officio Chairman)
Rajya Sabha max strength	250 (238 elected + 12 nominated)
President elected by	Electoral College (elected MPs + MLAs), STV/PR
President's pardoning power	Art 72
President's advice binding via	Art 74 (PM & Council)
Supreme Court established by	Art 124
Judicial review borrowed from	USA
Basic Structure doctrine case	Kesavananda Bharati (1973)
"Mini-Constitution" amendment	42nd (1976)
Amendment that removed Right to Property	44th (1978) → Art 300A
Voting age lowered 21→18	61st Amendment (1988)
Panchayati Raj / Municipalities	73rd / 74th Amendment (1992)
GST amendment	101st (2016)
Preamble words added by 42nd	Socialist, Secular, Integrity
Fundamental Duties borrowed from	USSR (Russia)
Federation with strong Centre from	Canada
Amendment procedure article	Art 368
Max gap between two Parliament sessions	6 months (Art 85)
Council of Ministers size cap	15% of Lok Sabha (91st Amendment)

PYQ pattern: "DPSP borrowed from?" → Ireland. · "Which amendment added Fundamental Duties?" → 42nd. · "Article dealing with UCC?" → Art 44. · "Money Bill defined in?" → Art 110.